

GrabFood and GoFood are not ad networks.

Your bid amplifies a position.

It does not create one.

What the customer funnel of 90 restaurants in Bali says about ad budgets. Reach, menu visits and orders, June to September 2026, plus payback by ad share from the 2026 benchmark.

Aleksei Mazur, founder of Delivery Booster. Keep swiping.

Two business models. Only one of them sells positions.

An ad network

Earns on impressions.

Auctions you a position.

Pay more, rank higher.

This is the model most owners run
their delivery ads on.

GrabFood / GoFood

Earns a commission on orders.

Its core asset is its own audience.

Ranks by one question: how well
does this listing monetise the
customers we send it?

**A listing that converts is promoted
for free. The platform earns more
from doing so.**

Which is why raising the budget on a listing that does not
convert buys you the same failure, faster.

What normal looks like on GrabFood in Bali

90 restaurants · 26 June to 23 September 2026 · 5.8 million people reached
Medians per restaurant, GrabMerchant dashboards

100

people see the restaurant in the app

7.4% open the menu

7.4

open the menu

11.5% of menu visitors order

0.8

place an order

0.82%

typical end-to-end conversion, reach to order

Best restaurant in the sample: 1.85%, more than twice the median, on the same kind of traffic.

Phuket, 13 restaurants: 8.5% open the menu, 11.7% of them order, 0.98% end to end, best 2.8%.



Ads move the first number. They do nothing to the other two.

Reach is what the budget buys. Whether people open the menu and whether they order is decided by the listing, and the ad pays for every visitor who leaves.

under 7%

open the menu

The problem is in the feed:

- cover photo
- name of the restaurant
- rating
- delivery time shown

under 11%

of menu visitors order

The problem is inside the menu:

- switched-off items
- photos on best sellers
- prices against the area
- promos and bundles

Every point below those medians is a share of the ad budget paid for nothing.

Where the money actually goes

Bali & Phuket Delivery Benchmark 2026 · 96 restaurants · 270,568 orders · January to August

25%

of delivery revenue is lost before it is earned.

95% of that is menu items switched off "for now" and never switched back on. Ads send people to a menu with holes in it.

10.4x

median ads payback, Bali

22.8x

median ads payback, Phuket

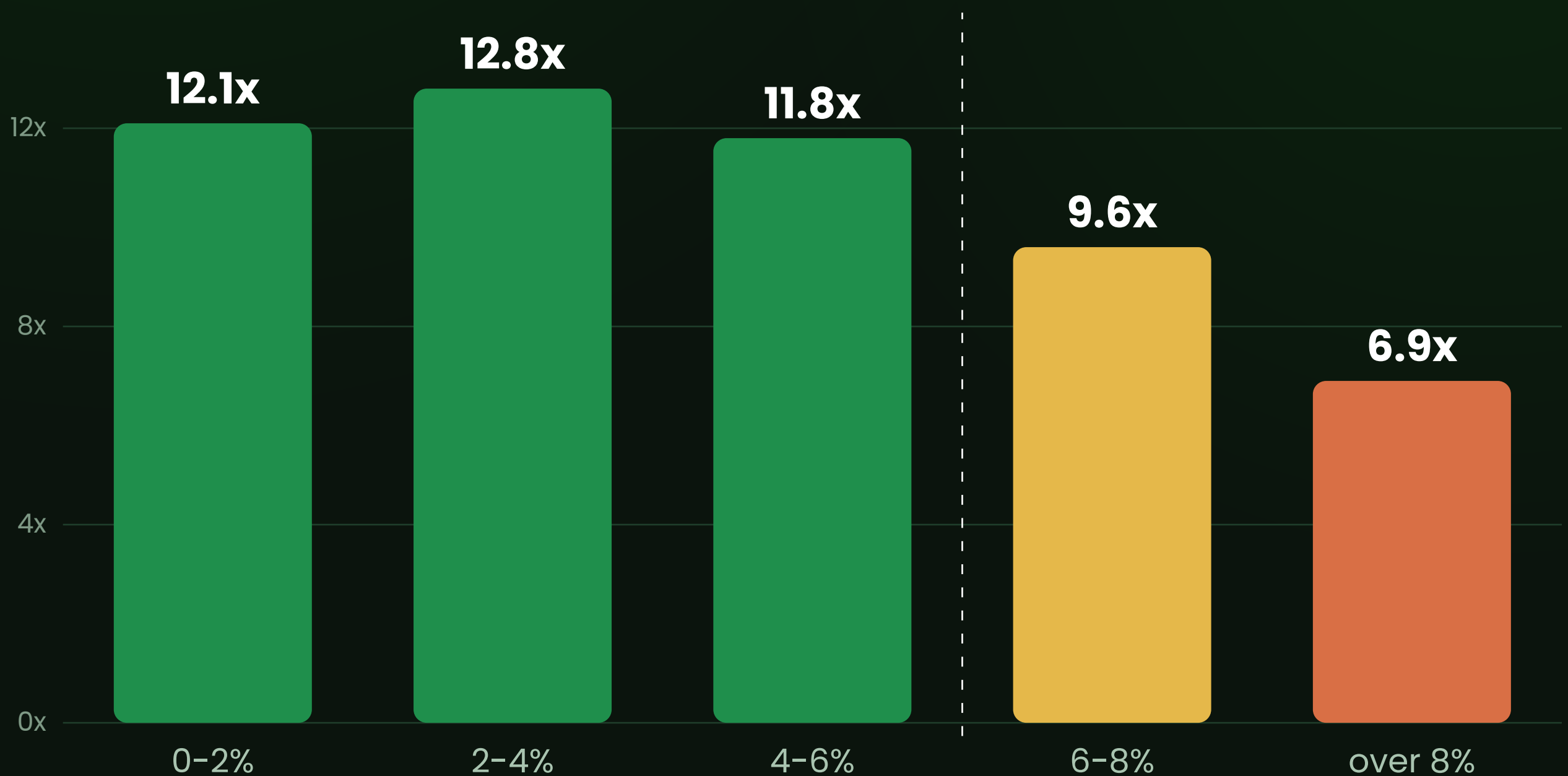
Only 6% of restaurants run below 5x.

Almost none of them has an ads problem. They have a listing problem that the ads are paying to expose.



The ceiling is 6% of revenue on ads

Median ROAS by share of revenue spent on ads · 96 restaurants, January to August 2026



Below the 6% line the median payback is 12.1x. Above it, 8.6x. 42% of the restaurants in the sample are already past the line.

Past 6%, every new rupiah buys impressions on customers who were already going to see you. Budget should follow conversion, not lead it.

Check this week, in this order, before touching the budget

1 Insights in GrabMerchant and GoBiz

Reach, menu visits, orders for the last 30 days. Compare with 7.4% and 11.5%. Reach up and orders flat is a conversion problem, not a reach problem.

2 The switched-off items report

Every dish that is off is a hole in the menu you are paying to advertise.

3 Photos and names on your best sellers

That is where the ad lands. Missing photo on a top seller is the cheapest fix with the biggest effect.

4 Rating trend and acceptance time, 30 days

Both feed the ranking directly. One-star reviews cost more than any bid buys back.

5 Only then raise the budget

And stop at 6% of revenue. Below that line the median payback is 12.1x, above it 8.6x.

The caveat we put on the page

This is a sample of agency-managed restaurants, not a random sample of the market. It is biased toward venues that are being watched every day.

Market-wide losses to switched-off items and wasted ad budget are almost certainly worse than the numbers here.

Two periods, two sources, both ours: the funnel is June to September 2026 from GrabMerchant dashboards; payback and losses are January to August 2026 from the published benchmark.

The full write-up, free, with every number

booster.delivery/answers/grabfood-ads-not-working

The five stages we run on every account: booster.delivery/method
Benchmark: booster.delivery/benchmark, updated every quarter.

